

FACTS ABOUT ASIA



Highest mountains

The Himalayas are the world's highest mountain range and contain the highest point on Earth—Mount Everest—which reaches 29,028 ft (8,848 m).

Number of birds

About 2,600 species of bird live in tropical Asia, from India in the west to China in the east and the Indonesian islands of Sumatra and Java in the south. More than 600 species breed in the Philippines alone.

Biggest forest

The conifer forests of northern Asia, called the taiga, cover more than 4½ million sq miles (12 million sq km) from Scandinavia in the west to the coast of the Pacific Ocean in the east. The taiga is the largest forest in the world.

Most volcanoes

Java in Indonesia has about 50 volcanoes. Mount Bromo (below) is the biggest of them. Volcanic soils cover about 16 percent of Japan.



Largest delta

The delta of the Ganges and Brahmaputra rivers in India covers an area of 23,000 sq miles (60,000 sq km).

Deepest lake on Earth

Lake Baikal in Siberia is the largest lake in Asia. It is 5,317 ft (1,637 m) deep and contains one-fifth of all the fresh water on Earth.

Highest rainfall

Cherrapunji in India has the highest rainfall in the world—425 in (10,800 mm) a year.

Typical birds

Here are just a few examples of typical birds from the most important habitats of Asia. You can find out more about typical birds and their habitats on the next few pages.



Rainforest

This orange-breasted trogon is one of 12 species of trogon that live in Southeast Asian rainforests. Other typical rainforest birds of the region include hornbills, barbets, broadbills, pittas, and sunbirds.



Conifer forest

Crossbills are common birds in the vast taiga forest of northern Asia. Other forest birds include jays, waxwings, owls, tits, woodpeckers, nutcrackers, and grouse.



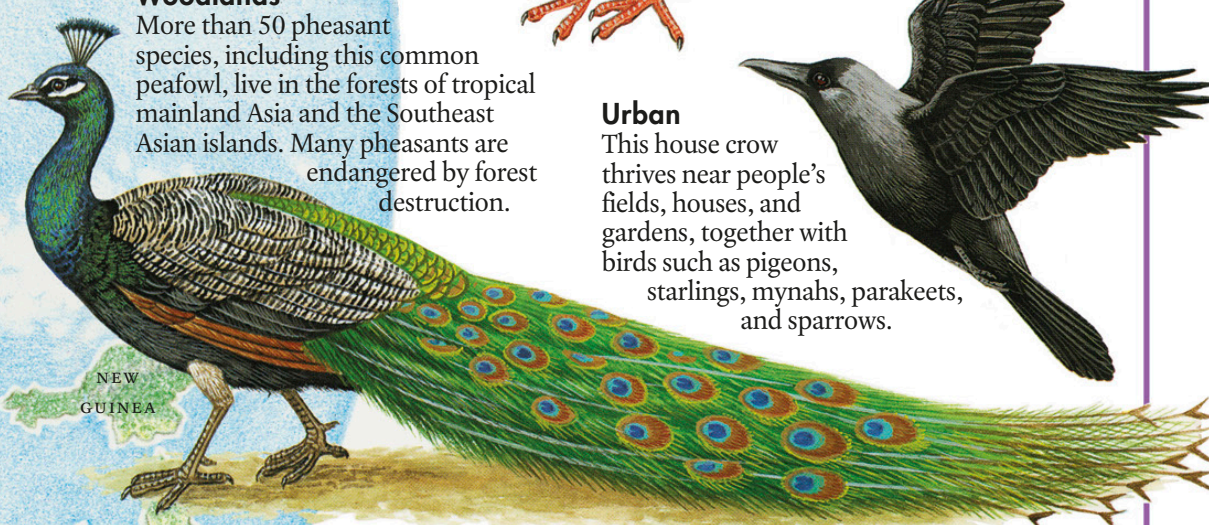
Desert and scrubland

Shrikes, larks, chats, and sandgrouse, feed on insects and seeds in this habitat. This long-tailed shrike is an aggressive predator that feeds on frogs as well as other birds.



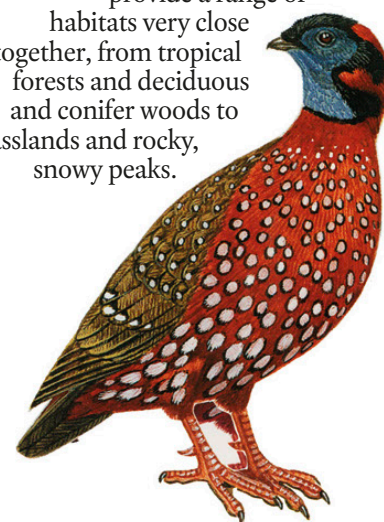
Woodlands

More than 50 pheasant species, including this common peafowl, live in the forests of tropical mainland Asia and the Southeast Asian islands. Many pheasants are endangered by forest destruction.



Mountains

Birds such as this satyr tragopan live high on mountains in summer and move lower down in winter. Asian mountains provide a range of habitats very close together, from tropical forests and deciduous and conifer woods to grasslands and rocky, snowy peaks.



Rivers, lakes, and swamps

The Asian openbill stork shares its watery habitat with other storks, herons, rails, cranes, spoonbills, ibises, ducks, geese, and swans.



Urban

This house crow thrives near people's fields, houses, and gardens, together with birds such as pigeons, starlings, mynahs, parakeets, and sparrows.

